CHUNGMANN KIM

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DEVELOPMENT ECONOMIST | HUMANITARIAN RESEARCHER | DATA SCIENTIST

PROFILE

I am a development economist and humanitarian researcher working on food security, nutrition and humanitarian finance. My research asks who is counted as being in need and who is missed, whether aid reaches the places where needs are greatest, and whether it arrives in time. Because the answers depend on the evidence itself, I study the indicators, classifications and models that decision-makers rely on, combining causal and spatial econometrics with survey, administrative and text data, and using AI where conventional data fall short.

CURRENT POSITION

- **Bloomberg School of Public Health, Johns Hopkins University** *Jan 2026 – Present*
  Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Center for Humanitarian Health Baltimore, MD
  - **Humanitarian finance:** subnational allocation of humanitarian aid relative to needs across 13 crisis countries
  - **Climate, conflict and displacement:** spatial models for Iraq in an FCDO-funded study with Mali

EDUCATION

- **University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign** *2025*
  Ph.D. in Applied Economics (Agricultural and Consumer Economics); advisor: Kathy Baylis United States
- **Seoul National University** *2019*
  M.Sc. in Agricultural Technology Republic of Korea
- **Handong Global University** *2015*
  B.Sc. in Environmental Studies, cum laude Republic of Korea

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

"**Official Estimates of Global Food Insecurity Undercount Acute Hunger**." Lentz, E., Baylis, K., Michelson, H., & **Kim, C.** (2025). ***Nature Food*** 6(12): 1196–1208. *AAEA Quality of Research Discovery Award.* [Article] [Code]

"**Inside the Black Box: How Consistent Are Global Food Security Crisis Analyses?**" Lentz, E., Baylis, K., Michelson, H., & **Kim, C.** (2026). ***Food Policy*** 138: 103028. [Article] [Code]

"**Machine Learning for Food Security: Principles for Transparency and Usability**." Zhou, Y., Lentz, E., Michelson, H., **Kim, C.**, & Baylis, K. (2022). ***Applied Economic Perspectives and Policy*** 44(2): 893–910. [Article]

"**Exploring the Association between Agricultural Production Systems and Household Diets in Viet Nam**." Bandyopadhyay, A., Azzarri, C., Haile, B., **Kim, C.**, et al. (2022). ***Food Security*** 14(5): 1207–1226. [Article]

"**The Economics of the Soy Kit for Food Entrepreneurs**." **Kim, C.** & Goldsmith, P. (2021). ***Food and Nutrition Bulletin***. [Article]

WORKING PAPERS

"**Hearing the Alarm: Do Donors Follow Institutional Crisis Signals?**" [Draft]
Staggered difference-in-differences on a geocoded, purpose-labelled aid dataset; food-security aid rises after IPC Phase 4 escalations in Afghanistan, but with substantial delay. UNU-WIDER 2025, EAAE 2025, AAEA 2025, APHA 2026.

"**Early-Year Milk Price and Child Stunting in Zambia**." [Draft] [Slides]
Higher milk prices at 12–24 months of age raise stunting risk among children aged 24–59 months. AAEA 2022, EAAE 2023, Tata-Cornell 2023, APHA 2026.

"**Multidimensional Food Security Indicators: Evidence from Sub-Saharan Africa**." With Baylis, K., Lentz, E., & Michelson, H. AAEA 2022.

POLICY AND TECHNICAL WORK

IPC Accuracy Study (with Lentz, Baylis & Michelson), IPC report, 2024 [Report] · **LACI framework** for reviewing AI and statistical models, FAO with EC-JRC, 2025–2026 [GitHub] · **News-based early warning** prototype, FAO with Kickstart AI, 2025 [Note] · **Viet Nam diagnostic overview**, IFPRI, 2021 [Report]

Professional Experience

- **FAO, IPC Global Support Unit** *Feb 2024 – Present*
  Data Scientist and Modelling Specialist, consultant (part-time) Home-based
  ◦ Lead development of the LACI model-review framework; focal point for the EC-JRC collaboration; validated a news-based early-warning prototype (South Sudan)
- **International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD)** *Sep 2023 – Jan 2024*
  Impact Assessment Specialist, consultant (part-time) Home-based
  ◦ Harmonized IFAD11/12 impact-assessment data across more than ten countries and automated the data pipelines
- **FAO, IPC Global Support Unit** *Oct 2022 – Aug 2023*
  Food Security Analyst, consultant (part-time) Home-based
  ◦ Led the empirical analysis of the IPC Accuracy Study (more than 10,000 subnational analyses)
- **International Food Policy Research Institute (IFPRI)** *Oct 2018 – Jan 2019*
  Research Intern Washington, DC
- **Canaan Farmer School** *2015 – 2017*
  Agricultural development project, Kilosa District (intern, then Project and Training Officer) Korea & Tanzania

Teaching, Talks and Honors

Teaching: ACE 251 The World Food Economy (Fall 2024; weekly lectures) · ACE 435 Global Agribusiness Management (TA, 2022, 2023), University of Illinois

Invited talks: Cornell CIDER Thought Summit (2026) · Johns Hopkins Food Assistance Strategic Dialogue (2026) · Stanford FSE seminar (2025) · UNU-WIDER (2025)

Honors: AAEA Quality of Research Discovery Award (2025) · Top-5 finalist, Johns Hopkins AI + Health Care Idea Tank (2026) · ACE Doctoral Fellowship (2025) · UNU-WIDER travel grant (2025)

Service: Referee, *Nature Food*, *BMC Public Health* · Member, IPC ATARI Working Group · Member, AAEA and EAAE

Methods and Tools

Econometrics: staggered DiD and event studies · panel fixed effects · spatial econometrics · IV, RD, matching
AI in research: LLM extraction and classification with human review · validation against official records · model review (LACI) · random forest, gradient boosting, LASSO
Tools: Stata · R · Python · SQL · Google Cloud · Earth Engine · QGIS · Git **Languages:** Korean (native), English (fluent), Chinese (intermediate)

References

Kathy Baylis
Professor and Vice-Chair, Geography
University of California, Santa Barbara
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Erin Lentz
Associate Professor, LBJ School
University of Texas at Austin
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Hope Michelson
Professor, Agricultural and Consumer Economics
University of Illinois Urbana–Champaign
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